

Professional Summary

I help organizations develop, implement, and operate strategic systems, programs, processes, and delivery improvements which lead to increased execution success, customer value, business growth, resource utilization, and employee engagement. I help ensure alignment of business goals and technical solutions within strategic leadership priorities. My co-workers recognize me as efficiently delivering complex business solutions with exceptional trust-building, problem solving, coaching, and communication clarity. I am results oriented with a collaborative style, unwavering integrity, and focus on customer and team success. My strengths include:

- Complex Solution Delivery
- Operations / Process Efficiency
- Team Building / Development
- Risk / Change Management
- Servant Leadership
- Organizational Alignment
- Agile Methodologies
- Cybersecurity Prioritization
- Program / Project Management
- Vendor Management
- Cloud-based Solutions
- Estimating / Budgeting / ROI

Professional Experience

Ross Enterprises – Des Moines, IA **Principal / Consultant**

Jan 2024 – Present

- I provide portfolio management, process improvement, leadership strategy, and communications support for critical systems and business transformation initiatives as requested.
- Responsible for deliverables including plans, proposals, process, configuration, architecture, development, security, and deployment recommendations.
- Technologies & tools used: JIRA, Smartsheet, MS Project, Teams, SharePoint, PowerPoint, Visio, and M365.

Office of the Iowa Secretary of State – Des Moines, IA **CIO / Director of IT**

June 2023 – Jan 2024

- Leadership responsibility with oversight support for IT staff, vendor consultants, technical help desk operations, incremental business services feature delivery, cybersecurity management, and system maintenance upgrades.
- Primarily Microsoft Azure hosted department platforms including public websites, Dynamics GP, MS Teams, SharePoint, Microsoft 365, including numerous web- and desktop-based custom business applications.
- Maintained security operations leveraging leading cyber security products and service providers: Check Point, Cisco WAF, BugCrowd, Okta, CISA, and DHS among others.

Wellabe, Inc. – Des Moines, IA

Oct 2020 – May 2023

Senior Project Manager, Digital Transformation

- Led multiple strategic digital transformation efforts reporting directly to the CIO working with executive sponsors while coordinating cross-functional delivery teams made up of business, IT, and external vendor staff.
- Managed implementation of a cloud-based insurance product application processing and underwriting platform to replace a home-grown, end-of-life system. Primary products: Med Supp, Preeed, Final Expense, Dental, HI.
- Coordinated custom developed API-based digital distribution channel delivery with internal sales, underwriting, development, QA, and external partners. Projected sales growth of \$110M over a 3-year period.
- Identified API-based digital distribution channel specific business operations and support process changes needed for internal customer support and external partner pilot launch.
- Technologies & tools used: Azure DevOps, Azure API Management Service, MS Teams, MS SharePoint, MS Project, ProductPlan, Microsoft 365, SpiraTest, Zoom, & MS Power Platform.

Launch IT Corp. (client City Hall of San Jose, CA – Silicon Valley)

Jan 2018 – Aug 2020

Senior Consultant / Program Manager

- Led final 2½ years of a ~4-year \$8M platform upgrade and multi-system integration for 10th largest city in U.S.
- Program scope included: Granicus (Amanda) Permitting System Upgrade 6.x to 7.4, ESRI ArcGIS integration, Avolve ProjectDox integration, and data quality improvements.
- Personally configured City of San Jose's Atlassian JIRA system with custom workflows & dashboards to drive agile delivery best practices working in 2-week sprint cycles with scrum teams made up of business and IT resources.
- Developed and maintained both product boards and task-based project plans to track billable delivery milestones.
- Technologies & tools used: Atlassian JIRA, MS Project, MS Teams, SharePoint, PowerPoint, Visio, and Office 365.

Berkley Technology Services, a Berkley Company - Urbandale, IA

Sep 2013 - Nov 2017

Project Manager / PMO

- Managed 24 distinct projects over 4 years, with budgets from \$25k to \$1.8M, matrix team sizes from 10 to 50+.
- Led multiple 9 to 18-month core business implementations and integration of custom policy administration systems, claims processing, web portals, data warehousing, regulatory reporting, and other 3rd party systems.
- Utilized JIRA to support introduction of agile methodologies on various product based projects.
- Technologies & tools used: Atlassian JIRA, MS Project, SharePoint, PowerPoint, Visio, and Office 365.

WDS, A Xerox Company (client Sprint Wireless at Corp HQ in Kansas City)

Nov 2012 - Aug 2013

Director, Solution Delivery, Digital Channels

- Client-facing executive consulting on customer satisfaction improvement and “share of wallet” strategies including: customer interaction analysis, self-service solutions, first-call resolution, and product mix / profitability statistics.
- Managed successful delivery of customer self-serve capabilities across digital (web and mobile) channels to improve customer satisfaction and reduce customer support cost by > \$2.8M (annualized).
- Technologies & tools used: MS Outlook, Project, Smartsheet, SharePoint, PowerPoint, Visio, and MS Office.

BalancePoint Solutions - Kansas City, MO

Jul 2011 - Aug 2012

Chief Practice Executive

- Successful delivery of ~\$3.5M revenue over an 13-month period with leadership oversight of all solutions practice activity including sales, client management, business strategy, operations, personnel, and process improvement.
- Client-facing executive managing teams responsible for custom software development, SharePoint customizations, technology investment consulting, and mobile strategy advice.
- Led practice growth of ~85% from 14 to 26 billable persons in the first 7 months.
- Implemented agile framework to increase software delivery velocity.
- Technologies & tools used: Team Foundation Server, Visual Studio, SQL, MS Project, Smartsheet, SharePoint, PowerPoint, Visio, and MS Office.

Trabon Solutions - Kansas City, MO

Sep 2005 - May 2011

Custom Software Engagement Manager / Project Manager

- Client-facing project management role in custom software development engagements responsible for coordinating all aspects of client requirements, design, testing, delivery, client training, and post-delivery customer support.
- Led successful \$2.75M web-based, multi-tenant application development project for the residential home construction industry designed to improve a builders’ operational efficiency and increase profitability.
- Managed \$200k .NET application development project for Johnson & Johnson providing ADHD symptom tracking capability with historical trending to support improved doctor/patient communications and treatment planning.
- Technologies & tools used: MS Project, SharePoint, SSRS, Team Foundation Server, PowerPoint, and MS Office.

YRC Worldwide Technologies - Kansas City, MO

Jan 2005 - Sep 2005

Project Manager - Contractor

- Project Manager leading various Sales and Marketing system enhancements utilizing scrum framework and test-driven development to support improved sales bonus structure control and marketing operation efforts.
- Led enterprise content management tool selection process to consolidate 3 tools into 1 to eliminate redundant licensing and support costs while maintaining individual business unit operations autonomy and strategy needs.
- Technologies & tools used: MS Project, PowerPoint, and MS Office.

Best Buy Co., Inc. - Minneapolis, MN

Jul 1998 - Jun 2004

Systems Development Manager, CRM & Contact Center Support Systems

- Team manager supporting CRM and Call / Contact Center solutions strategy, development, support, and implementation efforts to meet corporate business operations and financial goals with project teams up to 35 resources and annual budgets of \$4.3M
- Supported internal & remote call center locations with customer request workflow and agent workforce scheduling.
- Responsible for delivery of \$2.5M investments in CRM database integration, on-line customer profile tracking, customer service order management, automated email response management, and phone system integration.
- Technologies & tools used: Oracle, Avaya Lucent, MS Project, PowerPoint, and MS Office.

Education

Iowa State University – Bachelor of Science, Industrial Technology

Training and Certifications

- Cybersecurity for Executives (2023)
- AINS certification (2016)
- Financial **Management**: Budgeting Essentials
- PMP certification, (2004-2007, expired)
- Corporate **Management** Series Training
- Microsoft Azure: Identity & Access Mgmt (2023)
- Scrum Master, PSM I certification (2012)
- Building Consulting Relationships
- Managing Virtual Team Relationships
- ISACA CISA (1998 - certification exam only)

Professional and Civic Affiliations

- **Project Management** Institute (ID 521444)
- United Way, Volunteer
- Youth Competitive Baseball Coach
- Rebuilding Together, Team **Lead** Volunteer
- Meals from the Heartland, Volunteer

Technology Experience

MS Teams, SharePoint, JIRA, Confluence, Microsoft 365, Excel VBA, MS **Project**, Smartsheet, ProductPlan, Visio, SpiraTest, CoPilot, ChatGPT, Microsoft Power Apps, Bugcrowd, Azure DevOps, AWS, Azure Entra ID, CheckPoint, Microsoft Defender for Cloud, ManageEngine ServiceDesk Plus, EndPoint Central, Balsalmiq, Visual Studio, GitHub, HTML, CSS, XML, Javascript, WP Engine, SketchFlow, Microsoft SSRS, SQL, Dynamics CRM, VOIP, SiteFinity, Google Analytics, Daptiv, Avaya Lucent, COBIT, **Risk** Controls, Access, FoxPro, AutoCAD, and many other cloud, server, windows, browser, and mobile based technologies.

Chris Ross

- Earlham, IA, US

Contact Information

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Summary

Proven leader in the areas of solution delivery, team building, change adoption, facilitating collaboration, systems integration, value creation, crisis **management**, performance improvement, and contract negotiations. Successful **manager** of product and application development teams, systems delivery, process improvement, **risk** mitigation, and stakeholder relationships across a variety of business segments including insurance, transportation, residential construction, **customer** support, online learning, retail, product repair services, CRM, telecommunications, content **management**, financial services, and manufacturing. Specialties: Team leadership, conflict resolution, stakeholder collaboration, programproject **management**, problem solving, ROI driven, process improvement, systems audit, and **risk** controls.

Work History

Total Work Experience: 26 years

- **Principal / PM Consultant Ross Enterprises**
Jan 01, 2024
- **CIO / Director Of IT Office Of The Iowa Secretary Of State**
Jun 01, 2023
- **Senior Project Manager Wellabe**
Oct 01, 2020
- **Program Manager, Scrum Master, Consultant City Of San Jose, CA On Behalf Of Launch IT Corp**

Jan 01, 2018

- **Senior Project Manager** Berkley Technology Services
Sep 01, 2013
- **Director, Solution Delivery, Digital Channels WDS, A Xerox Company**
Nov 01, 2012
- **Chief Practice Executive, Solution Delivery Balance Point Solutions**
Jul 01, 2011
- **Custom Software Engagement Manager** Trabon Solutions
Sep 01, 2005
- **Project Manager**, Consultant YRC Worldwide Technologies
Jan 01, 2005
- **Development Manager, CRM & Customer Support Systems** Best Buy Co., Inc
Jul 01, 1998

Education

- **Bachelors** | Iowa State University

Skills

- agile methodologies
- business process improvement
- client development
- conflict resolution
- consulting
- contract negotiation
- **customer** relationship **management**
- financial services
- hiring personnel
- integration
- issue resolution
- **management**

- p&l **management**
- p&l responsibility
- partner **management**
- positive work environment
- professional scrum master i
- sharepoint
- software development
- software documentation
- strategy
- team building
- team leadership
- trusted advisor
- azure iam (entra) - 2 years
- ai, chatgpt, copilot - 1 years
- microsoft defender for cloud - 1 years
- azure devops - 2 years
- change **management** - 22 years
- **project management** - 22 years
- sdlc - 22 years
- microsoft **project** - 20 years
- solution delivery - 18 years
- **customer** engagement - 15 years
- engagement **management** - 15 years
- **management** consulting - 15 years
- process improvement - 15 years
- program **management** - 15 years
- jira - 12 years
- agile frameworks - 10 years
- microsoft sharepoint - 8 years
- scrum master - 8 years
- vba - 6 years
- **budget** - 15 years
- software development **management** - 16 years
- crm - 12 years
- security **management** - 11 years
- business analysis - 10 years
- team **management** - 9 years
- **customer** facing - 8 years
- strategic **planning** - 8 years
- it **management** - 6 years
- leadership - 5 years
- **senior management** - 5 years
- business operations - 6 years
- qa - 12 years
- sql - 7 years

- **release management** - 6 years
- **html css** - 4 years
- **smartsheet** - 2 years
- **email marketing** - 6 years
- **infrastructure** - 5 years
- **network** - 5 years
- **hardware** - 5 years
- **network management** - 3 years
- **cisa** - 2 years

Work Preferences

- Desired Work Settings: No Preference
- Likely to Switch: True
- Willing to Relocate: False
- Travel Preference: 25%
- Work Authorization:
 - US
- Work Documents:
 - US Citizen
- Security Clearance: False
- Desired Hourly Rate: 75+ (USD)
- Desired Salary: 140,000+ (USD)
- Third Party: False
- Employment Type:
 - Full-time
 - Contract - Independent
 - Contract - W2
 - Contract to Hire - Independent
 - Contract to Hire - W2

Profile Sources

- linkedin: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/chrisross9>
- Dice:
 - <https://www.dice.com/employer/talent/profile/d9d83b8c03a5e91bbdb581e85308153a>